

6 28010 002330

WEDNESDAY JANUARY 1, 2025
RAJAB 1, 1446

gulfnews.com

GULF NEWS



Scan for
our social
media

NATION | P4

**Workers in Dubai
more aware of
their rights**



THE VIEWS | P8

**Region needs a
new dawn for
peace and unity**



BUSINESS | P5

**Emirates bolsters
Kuwait, Bahrain,
Colombo routes**

ENTERTAINMENT | P15

**ANGELINA
JOLIE AND
BRAD PITT
REACH
DIVORCE
DEAL**



2025

ABC

Cargo, Courier,
Shipping, Logistics

800 916
www.abccargo.com

GULF NEWS WISHES
ITS READERS A
HAPPY NEW YEAR



UAE WELCOMES 2025

From Abu Dhabi to Dubai and Ras Al Khaimah, stunning fireworks lit up the night sky as residents and tourists from around the world ushered in the New Year



Nation:
UAE residents
talk about
their New Year
resolutions
and wishes
P2



Nation:
Friends,
families
and visitors
celebrate a
new beginning
P3



World:
People
welcome
2025 after
sweltering
year, turmoil
P10

Salamatt Husain/Gulf News

UAE sees modest salary increases

New year will see more Gulf firms invest in tech-driven projects

DUBAI

BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

Salary increases in the UAE and Gulf region for 2024 have been more modest than anticipated, with most employees receiving a 4 per cent to 6 per cent hike, according to a report by Dubai-based training institute Nadia Global.

Initial hopes for double-digit raises were tempered by economic factors and a growing talent pool. For new hires, compensation now aligns with market rates, but an in-

flux of overseas candidates willing to accept lower salaries is adding pressure to this balance.

High-demand skillsets for 2025 include expertise in AI, data science, software development, and analytics, as more Gulf firms invest in tech-driven projects. Sales and finance professionals are also sought after, mainly those skilled in corporate tax com-

The UAE's reputation as a global talent hub continues to grow, ranked as the fifth most popular relocation destination worldwide.

pliance, as the UAE implements its tax norms.

The UAE's reputation as a global talent hub continues to grow, ranked as the fifth most popular relocation destination worldwide. The country attracts professionals across finance, law, healthcare, and education, particularly from the UK, Europe, South America, and Asia.

However, this influx of talent is creating a competitive labor market, with many newcomers accepting below-market salaries to secure opportunities. Employers face challenges such as rising costs for mandatory benefits, including medical insurance, as they strive to retain skilled workers.

SEE ALSO P5

WORLD

SpaDeX: India to become 4th nation to achieve space docking | P11

MIDDLE EAST

Health care in Gaza nearing total collapse due to Israeli strikes | P9

SPORT

A look at the promising stars who will grab headlines in 2025 | P12



Subscribe in print and online
www.store.gulfnews.com
www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions
Tel : 600 587 234
Email : circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE
UAE: Dh 5.00
Bahrain: BD 0.500
Oman: RO 0.500
India: Rs 40.00
S.Arabia: SR 5.00
Pakistan: Rs 100.00

Hopes high for a better world in New Year

DESPITE WARS AND CLIMATE CRISIS, THERE'S PLENTY TO CHEER US IN 2025

DUBAI

BY ALEX ABRAHAM
Senior Associate Editor

Crowds marvelled at fireworks and dined at New Year's Eve parties across the globe yesterday to greet 2025, hoping the world would be a better place in the new year.

Much of this hope will depend on how we behave with the countries around us, the environment and with our neighbours.

Trump 2.0

On January 20, Donald Trump will take office as the 47th president of the United States, 11 weeks after his convincing win in the election against Democrat Kamala Harris.

Trump's return, at the age of 78, will be closely watched by allies and foes alike. He has vowed to Make America Great Again, retreating from multilateralism in favour of power politics. The government's new policies could reshape transatlantic security, support for Ukraine and affect trade policies.

What about the weather? It is all but certain that 2024 will go down as the hottest year on

record. Will 2025 be a better year for the environment, a year when our greenhouse gas emissions stop their steady climb around the world?

Researchers are pointing to the positive signs from China, responsible for 30 per cent of global emissions, where fossil fuel carbon dioxide emissions are projected to tick up only marginally this year. Even then, countries cannot afford to relax, and should quickly decrease their emissions to aim for carbon neutrality.

Closer home, a UN report published yesterday found that Israeli strikes on and near hospitals in the Gaza Strip had left health care in the Palestinian territory on the verge of collapse. UN human rights chief Volker Turk said Gaza hospitals had become a "death trap".

With more than 45,500 people killed in the Israel-Gaza war, there is a pressing need to end the conflict.

With AI advances on the horizon, rampant inflation tipped to slow, and K-pop megastars BTS returning to the stage after military service in South Korea, there is still plenty to look forward to in 2025.

GiGiS

Dear Gulf News Readers

As 2024 comes to a close, we at GiGiS extend our heartfelt gratitude for making us a part of your moments, big and small. From signing meaningful deals to penning personal notes.

Thank you for letting us be a part of your success stories.



Here's to 2025,
A year of bold beginnings and remarkable achievements.

"Discover GiGiS at leading hypermarkets, supermarkets, discount centers, stationery stores, or online on Amazon, Noon, and Tradeling—where inspiration begins!"

+971 50 527 9077
+971 4 297 1900

info@gigisglobal.com
gigisinternational.com

• Stationery • Opalware
• Thermoware • Household

GiGiS

3540772_11